

The Big Trust

What Was - Is For What Will Be

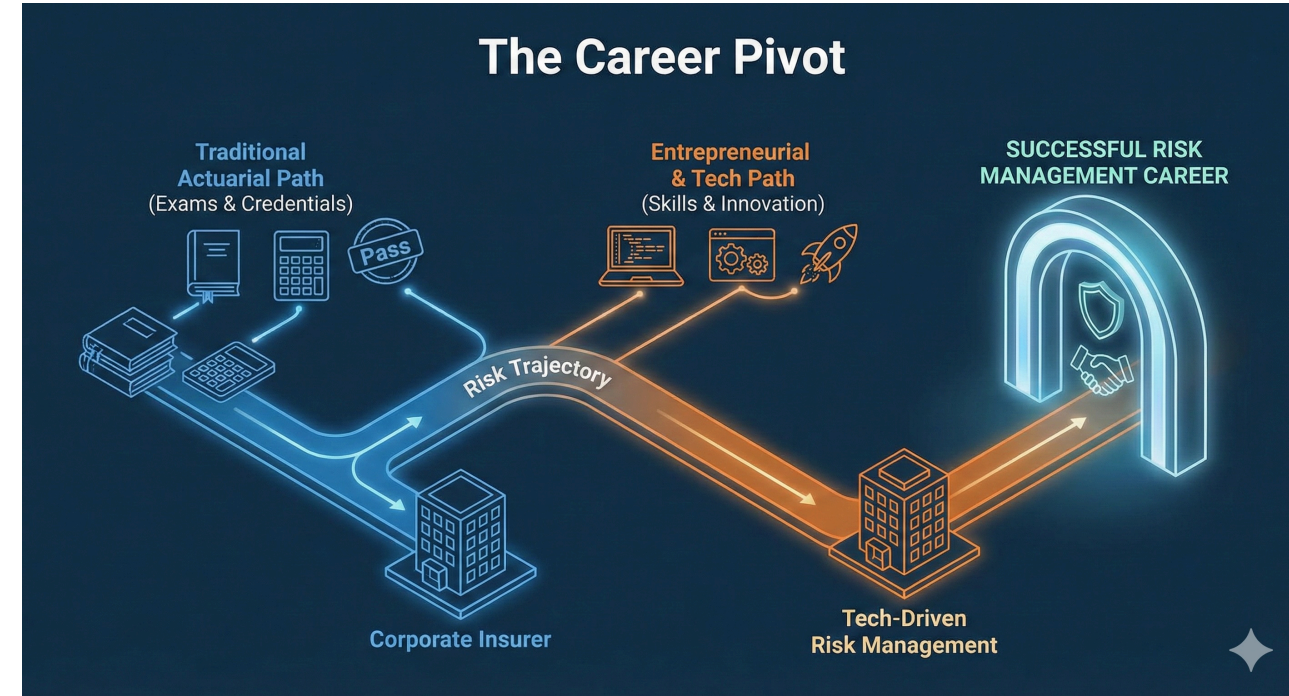
A Founder's Journey: From Risk Runners to Risk Management

*Presented to the Risk Runners Club, University of Arizona
February 17, 2026*

The Elephant in the Room

I founded this club, but I never passed an actuarial exam.

- **The Reality:** I oriented my entire life toward actuarial science, but the path wasn't linear.
- **The Outcome:** Orienting toward this discipline changed my life, even without the credentials.
- **The Goal Today:** To share the "Big Trust"—how understanding the architecture of risk can build a career, whether you pass the exams or not.



Origins: 10 Fingers vs. 100,000

Before the math, there was **Language & Code**.

- **2015:** Wrote a book on AI Philosophy.
- **The Tech:** Created [LinguaLint](#) (Natural Language Processing).
 - Scraped 1,500 news articles/day.
 - Extracted event codes to predict stock market trends.
- **The Realization:** It was a "lightweight LLM middleware."
 - *My 10 fingers* coding from scratch vs. the *100,000 fingers* that built ChatGPT.
- **The Shift:** Moved from UC Davis (Ag) → Poetry → U of A (Math/Finance) to find something "eternal" amidst rapid tech changes.



The Educational Crossroads

Why U of A?

- **The Choice:** ASU (Established Actuarial Program) vs. U of A (College Town Culture).
- **The Gap:** ASU had the funding, the WSIA events, and the Casualty Actuarial Society (CAS) connection. U of A did not.
- **The Solution:** Founded **Risk Runners**.
 - Bridging the gap.
 - Driving students to WSIA events.
 - Creating a community from scratch (0 to 1).

The Overload & The Hubris

I tried to do it all at once:

1. Math Degree (PDEs, Stochastic Processes).
2. Finance Program (Eller).
3. Running a Tech Company (Sensutech).
4. Latin & Systems Engineering.
5. **Running the Risk Runners Club.**
6. Exercise
7. Night Life

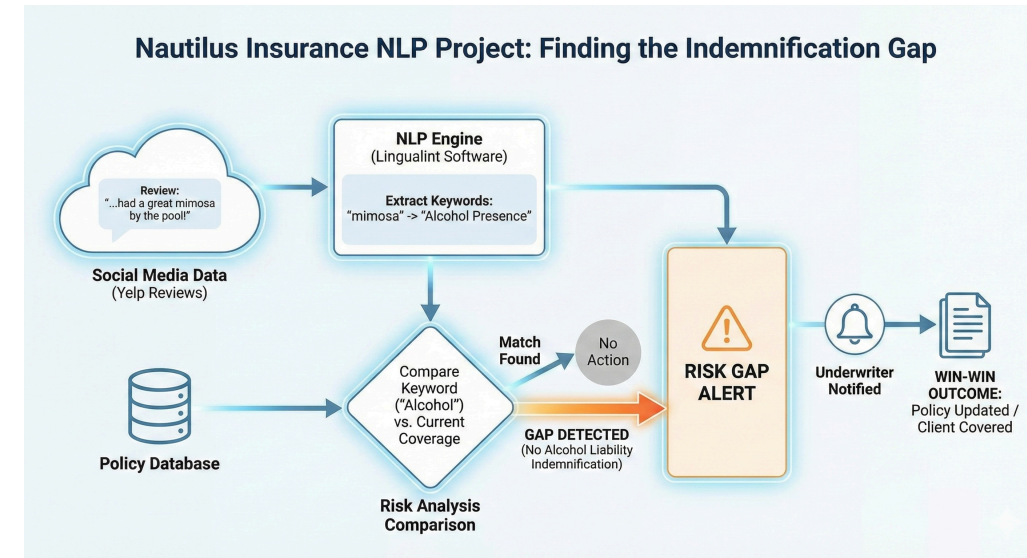
The Result: I took the Financial Math exam to "see how hard it was." **I failed.**
But in failing the exam, I got to see the bigger picture.

The Actuarial Internship: Nautilus Insurance

Thanks to Brent Carr @ Nautilus / Connection via WSIA

I applied my NLP software to the insurance world.

- **The Project:** Scraping Yelp reviews for hotel/motels.
- **The Insight:** "Great mimosa!" + No alcohol indemnification = **Risk Gap**.
- **The Win-Win-Win:**
 1. **Underwriter:** Knows the risk before the lawyers do.
 2. **Insurer:** Gets higher premiums for proper coverage.
 3. **Client:** Is actually covered for their reality.



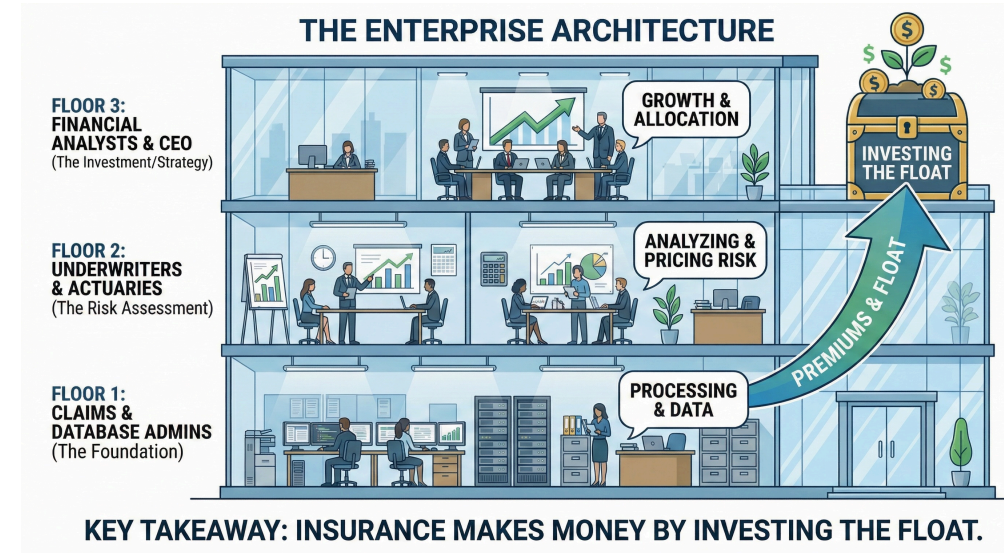
The Enterprise Architecture

What I learned inside the building.

Insurance isn't just math; it's a physical structure of talent.

- **Floor 1:** Claims & Database Admins (The Foundation).
- **Floor 2:** Underwriters & Actuaries (The Risk Assessment).
- **Floor 3:** Financial Analysts & CEO (The Investment/Strategy).

Key Takeaway: Insurance doesn't make money solely on premiums; it makes money by **investing the float**.



The Vision: A Tale of Two Societies

What Was - Is For What Will Be

I proposed a new model for Arizona education based on the two main societies:

CAS (Casualty)	SOA (Society of Actuaries)
Focus: Property/Product	Focus: Health/Life
Risk: Before/After Lifecycle	Risk: During Lifecycle
Analogy: The Lawyer	Analogy: The Doctor
School: ASU (State School)	School: U of A (University)

Goal: Give high schoolers a clear choice of path, just like choosing between Med School and Law School.

Career Trajectory: The Pivot

Post-2020: Adapting to the World

1. CPG Analytics (Remote Work)

- Started with simple tools.
- Mastered **Tableau** (Business Intelligence).
- *Action:* Taught others how to use Kaggle data + AI to build portfolios.

2. Veteran Affairs (Contractor)

- **Patient Generated Health Data (PGHD).**
- Wearables (Fitbit, Dexcom) predicting health risks.
- *The Actuarial Link:* Using continuous IoT data to predict insurance risk (Life/Health).

Current Frontier: Captive Insurance

Merging Housing & Risk

My market research led me to the housing crisis and **Prefab Manufacturing**.

- **The Strategy:** Applying the "Insurance Building" model to a smaller scale.
- **Captive Insurance:**
 - Like 12 doctors self-insuring to pool risk.
 - Capturing the premium + Investing the float.
- **The Focus:** [Captive Management for Prefab Manufacturers](#).



INTEGRAL MASS
CAPTIVE INSURANCE

What I Value (vs. Advice)

Academia vs. Industry

- **Academia:** Can trap you in a cycle of paying for credentials.
- **Industry:** Pays you for your time and values **work experience** and **tool mastery** (tech stack) over pure theory.

Work-Life Balance

- I value leaving work at work.
- Time for: Hiking, Poetry, Pickleball, Networking.
- *We work to live, we don't live to work.*

Resources & Community

Where to look next

- **AI Trailblazers:**
 - *Aaron Eden & Maria Eden.*
 - Bridging the gap between AI-literate and non-literate.
 - Training mentors to train apprentices.
- **Casualty Actuaries of the Desert States.**
- **Arizona Captive Insurance Association (AZCIA).**
- **Venture Café in Phoenix.**

Networking is critical.

The Final Thought

"What was - is for what will be."

I may go back and take those first two exams because they open doors. But my journey taught me that **Risk Management** is broader than just a test score.

It's about:

- Networking
- Technology
- Trust (In your path)

Thank you

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